

The policy clearly indicates the edge one gets with Arduino compared to other proprietary tools.

Ram explains, "Libraries as well as reference designs are the key things that any design engineer or hobbyist would like to have access to before starting with a design or project. For instance, any talk-of-the-town technology like GPS, GSM or accelerometers has ready-to-use libraries that a design engineer can instantiate with very little effort."

Libraries and reference designs will make it easy for designers to integrate Arduino into their electronics projects and vendors to clone these and sell variants.

8 Events adding to Arduino's popularity

There have been a lot of activities

around the Arduino platform in the last couple of years which have also helped in popularising it. Hacking events and workshops centred on the Arduino platform have become a common sight these days.

"Tenet has organised many events of late to encourage people to pick up Arduino," says Ram. Yahoo! India also recently conducted a hackfest on the Arduino platform. (You can find more details at <http://arduino.cc/blog/2011/07/25/adk-android-hacks-in-yahoo-open-hack-in-bangalore/>)

Can India build another Arduino?

Why are some true Open Source boards not coming from India when so much is happening in this space already? To this question, Chatterjee shares an interesting observation,

"We don't see a true Indian Open Source board because as a market we are still too immature to release the core files in the market. While people in India do build boards, we need to start building great user and developer communities around these. That is the key to the success of a good board with all the traits of Open Source. I hope the best Open Source FPGA board emerges out of India."

Ram concludes on a positive note: "Given the Open Source trend in India and more number of hacker spaces springing up, I am hopeful that very soon some projects from India will make it into the open hardware space in a big way." Till that happens, Arduino may well continue to reign! ●

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